

Profile

Personal Information

Name	HAYA, NAPHTAL <i>OBILLOH</i>
Preferred Name	NAPH
Sex, Birthdate	Male, 07/22/1996

Contact Details

Email, Phone	naftali10730@gmail.com, +254.704300100, Mobile, No other telephone
Permanent Address	P.O. Box 38740 Nairobi, Nairobi, 00600, KEN

Demographics

Military Status	None
Hispanic or Latino	No
Race	Black or African American (Africa)

Language

Dholuo	First Language, Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home
English	Speak, Read, Write
Swahili	Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home
Gikuyu	Speak, Read

Geography & Citizenship

Citizenship Status	Other (Non-US)
Birthplace	Nairobi, Kenya (0 Years US, 20 Years Non-US)
Other Citizenships	Kenya
Current US Visa	None
Intended US Visa	F-1 Student

CA Fee Waiver

Fee Waiver Requested	
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Yes, Signed: N.O. Haya

My annual family income falls within the Income Eligibility Guidelines set by the USDA
Food and Nutrition Service

I can provide a supporting statement from a school official, college access counselor,
financial aid officer, or community leader

Family

Household

Parents	Married
Home	Both Parents

Parent 1

Father

Name	Mr. JOSHUA H OBILLOH
Birthplace	Kenya
Email, Phone	+254.729626609, Mobile
Address	a different address P.O. Box 74 Reru, Kisumu, Nyanza, 40100, KEN
Occupation	Other, Casual labourer, Unemployed
Education	Some trade school or community college No Degree, Egerton University, Nakuru, KEN

Parent 2

Mother

Name	Mrs. Risper A HAYA (ONDIEK)
Birthplace	Kenya
Email, Phone	+254.717003102, Mobile
Address	the same as my home address
Occupation	Other, Casual labourer, Unemployed
Education	Some grade/primary school

Siblings

1. SETH A HAYA, Age 30, Brother, Completed grade/primary school
2. WYCLIFF O HAYA, Age 19, Brother, Some high/secondary school
3. ESTHER A HAYA, Age 16, Sister, Some high/secondary school
4. MICHAEL O HAYA, Age 14, Brother, Some grade/primary school

Education

Current or Most Recent Secondary School

Alliance High School, Kikuyu, KEN, Public, CEEB: 619330 (02/2013 - 11/2016)

Counselor Ms. GLADYS N OTIDO, Careers Counselor
Email, Phone gnanzala2010@gmail.com, +254.722354971
Boarding School Yes: Living at School
Progression Did or will take gap year
Graduation Date 11/2016

Colleges & Universities

Grades

Rank 6 / 399, Unweighted
GPA 3.9 / 4, Unweighted

Current or Most Recent Year Courses

First Trimester	Second Trimester	Third Trimester
English	English	English
Mathematics	Mathematics	Mathematics
Kiswahili	Kiswahili	Kiswahili
Biology	Biology	Biology
Chemistry	Chemistry	Chemistry
Physics	Physics	Physics
Electricity	Electricity	Electricity
Christian Religious Education	Christian Religious Education	Christian Religious Education

Honors

Valedictorian, Class of 2016	School	12
Position 1, Chemistry, National Science & Math Olympiad	National	12

Position 2, Biology, National Science & Math Olympiad	National	12
Position 1, Sub-County, Energy Category, Kenya Science & Engineering Fair	State/Regional	12
Position 5, Carey Francis Memorial Mathematics Contest	State/Regional	12

Community-Based Organizations

CBO 1	KenSAP (Kenya Scholar-Athlete Project)
Counselor	Mr. John Manners
Email, Phone	jhmanners@gmail.com, +1.973-783-1592

Future Plans

Engineer, Doctorate

Testing

SAT (March 2016 or after)

Evidence-based Reading and Writing	700	10/07/2017
Math	740	10/07/2017
Essay	17	10/07/2017
Taken	1	
Planned	0	
SAT Essay	Yes	

SAT Subject Tests

Chemistry	11/2017
Physics	11/2017

Leaving Exams

English	B+	11/2016, Actual, KCSE
Mathematics	A	11/2016, Actual, KCSE
Kiswahili	A-	11/2016, Actual, KCSE
Biology	A	11/2016, Actual, KCSE
Chemistry	A	11/2016, Actual, KCSE
Physics	A	11/2016, Actual, KCSE
Electricity	A	11/2016, Actual, KCSE
Christian Religious Education	A	11/2016, Actual, KCSE

Activities

Internship

PG	Customer Service Officer, Equity Bank
Year	Offered position based on national exam result. In charge of customer satisfaction in local branch. My branch ranked third in customer satisfaction.
47 hr/wk, 24 wk/yr	

Student Govt./Politics

11, 12	Senior Captain in charge of protocol and routine
School	One of 22 student officers with significant duties. Headed department charged with receiving guests and ensuring time management.
8 hr/wk, 39 wk/yr	

Student Govt./Politics

11	Chairman, House Committee
School	In dorm of 150, charged with maintaining order and cleanliness and organizing house teams for various inter-house competitions.
6 hr/wk, 39 wk/yr	

Community Service (Volunteer)

9, 10, 11, 12, PG	Tutor, Local Primary Schools
Break, Year	Taught mathematics, science, English, and sex education at local primary schools. Mentored students and prepared them for national exams.
20 hr/wk, 4 wk/yr	
Continue	

Other Club/Activity

11, 12	Secretary, Electricity Club
School	Organized club activities such as field trips; assisted contestants in science fairs; helped members conduct practical applications of classwork.
2 hr/wk, 39 wk/yr	
Continue	

Athletics: JV/Varsity

10, 11, 12	Handball, Pivot (defender); later team manager
School	Team reached county level in national competition (2015).
10 hr/wk, 39 wk/yr	

Religious

9, 10, 11, 12, PG	Vice-Chairman, Sunday School Society
Year	Taught children religion and hygiene at my church and at Dagoretti Children's Centre.
4 hr/wk, 42 wk/yr	
Continue	

Community Service (Volunteer)

9, 10, 11, 12	Founder, Local Youth Group
Break	Created local youth group with fellow students. Engaged in various community service projects, chiefly clearing litter and removing garbage.
4 hr/wk, 4 wk/yr	
Continue	

Community Service (Volunteer)

9, 10, 11	Member, Red Cross Society.
School	Participated in the Red Cross walk to eradicate jiggers (insects) in Kikuyu Sub-county. Learned first aid skills.
1 hr/wk, 15 wk/yr	
Continue	

Other Club/Activity

PG	Yellow Belt, Taekwondo, Fluorspar Dojo
Year	Four months training in martial arts skills at village dojo. Earned Yellow Belt. Currently working on Orange.
3 hr/wk, 14 wk/yr	
Continue	

Writing

Personal Essay

The lessons we take from obstacles we encounter can be fundamental to later success. Recount a time when you faced a challenge, setback, or failure. How did it affect you, and what did you learn from the experience?

When I was an infant my parents moved from our home in Kisumu on the shores of Lake Victoria to Limuru in Kenya's Central Highlands. The two towns are 300 km apart, but the cultural distance is greater. Kisumu is home to my people, the Luo; Limuru is in the land of the Kikuyu. The two tribes are longtime rivals for political power.

My father had found a job at a Limuru timber company, but the company closed down within a year and my father eventually moved to Tanzania in search of work, accompanied by the youngest of his three wives. My four siblings and I stayed in Limuru with my mother. We had been welcomed into the local community, and my mother began working as a laundress. Her income could barely feed us; she could not pay for our education. I was only able to join pre-school at age seven, courtesy of a generous neighbor. After a year of preschool, I entered a local primary school, which fortunately charged no fee.

At the end of 2007, as I was about to enter Class 5, Kenya's disputed general election caused a nationwide eruption of ethnic violence, with the Luo and Kikuyu on opposite sides. Neighbors butchered each other mercilessly. We fled our home and sought asylum at a displaced persons camp in Nairobi. Our home in Limuru went up in flames the next day.

We lived in the displaced persons camp for a year, and my siblings and I missed nine months of school. I began to think I'd never set foot in school again and would have work menial jobs like my older brother, who had begun work after Class 8 to help support the family. Eventually my mother managed to get us admitted to M.M. Chandaria Primary, and to get support from a Catholic charity for our uniforms and lunches. We also received a bit of government help to move out of the displaced persons camp and into a predominantly Luo neighborhood nearby.

I was disappointed to be placed back in Class 4 after having been out of school so long, but I felt a strong compulsion to study hard to fulfill my brother's frustrated academic aspirations. I would be the first in our family to join high school. In 2012, I sat the national primary school examinations and emerged the top student in Kasarani District. I received a letter of admission from my dream school, Alliance High School, but I was instantly confronted by the cruel reality that my family could not afford the astronomically high fees.

Two weeks before I was due at Alliance, my head teacher at Chandaria Primary told me about a scholarship offered by Kenya Commercial Bank Foundation. I completed the application form and went through a lengthy interview on my background. The Foundation even visited my home and primary school. With just four days left, I was informed via phone that I received the scholarship, sponsoring me for all four years at Alliance.

I got off to a bad start. I suppose I was disconcerted to be studying among students from "rival" communities. Fortunately, at the end of my first term, a talented motivational speaker addressed the school about national cohesion, and I was inspired to take advantage of Alliance's multi-ethnic population rather than retreat from it. I settled in and I ranked among the top three in my form in all subsequent term examinations, eventually being named Valedictorian of the Class of 2016. In the national high school final examination, I emerged one of the best students in the country.

I believe the successive shocks of my father's departure, the post-election violence, my family's displacement and the need to adapt repeatedly to new environments have all taught me to grasp the opportunities hidden behind obstacles, and to make the most of them for myself and my community.

Additional Information

In the family section I listed my four full siblings. However, my father is married to three wives. My mother is my father's second wife. Here is the list of my father's other wives and my half-siblings. My father supports all his wives and children.

Rose Adhiambo Haya (First wife)

1. Benta Haya (half-sibling), born 1972

Dorcas Adhiambo Haya (Third wife)

HALF-SIBLINGS

1. Chillion Haya, born 1989
2. Rose Haya, born 1990
3. Norah Haya, born 1992
4. Pamela Haya, born 1993
5. Jedidah Haya, born 1996
6. Elijah Haya, born 1998
7. Teresa Haya, born 2001
8. Joshua Haya Jr., born 2004
9. Naphtal Haya Jr., born 2006

Education Progression

Education progression details

Did or will take gap year

Required Explanation

Education progression

Kenyan high school graduates who qualify for university must wait ten months or more after finishing school before joining university. After completing my high school exams in November 2016, I travelled to my maternal aunt's home near Lake Victoria to help her plant maize and beans on her one-acre farm and look after her three cows and four goats.

In mid-December I travelled back to Nairobi and began tutoring my younger brother, who is currently preparing for his high school exams. I also gave holiday instruction and mentoring to primary school pupils at my former school. In addition, I conducted Sunday School sessions at my local church, assisted the pharmacist at a nearby public hospital with packaging medicine, and led community litter pick ups.

When results of the national high school exam were announced, Equity Bank offered me an internship as a customer service officer in a local Nairobi branch. I worked at the bank for five months.

In June, I joined KenSAP, a highly selective college access program that helps talented, needy young Kenyans to apply to elite US colleges. During the program's 15 weeks of residential training, I prepared for the SAT, worked on college applications, tutored pupils at a local primary school, earned a yellow belt in Taekwondo and improved my running fitness.

I intend to return to work at Equity Bank in January after spending the December holiday at my family's rural home. I will work at the Bank until I join university in August.

Disciplinary Information

Have you ever been found responsible for a disciplinary violation at any educational institution you have attended from the 9th grade (or the international equivalent) forward, whether related to academic misconduct or behavioral misconduct, that resulted in a disciplinary action?

No

Have you ever been adjudicated guilty or convicted of a misdemeanor or felony?

No

Harvard University Questions

General

Preferred start term	Fall 2018
Admission plan	Restrictive Early Action
Preferred residence	On Campus
Financial aid	Yes
Do you intend to submit supplementary materials to be considered as part of the admission process to Harvard? Portfolio materials can illustrate special talents in academics or in one or more of the arts. These materials should be included only if you think they would significantly add to your application. Please see the website for more information.	No

Academics

What academic program at Harvard interests you?	Engineering
On a scale of 1 (Absolutely Certain) to 5 (Very Likely to Change), how definite do you consider your academic plans to be?	2

On a scale of 1 3
(Absolutely
Certain) to 5 (Very
Likely to Change),
how definite do
you consider your
vocational plans to
be?

On a scale of 1 1
(Absolutely
Certain) to 5 (Very
Likely to Change),
how definite are
your
extracurricular
and/or athletic
interests?

Are you applying No
for the dual degree
program with the
New England
Conservatory?

Are you applying No
for the dual degree
program with
Berklee College of
Music?

Online Coursework No

Additional Intellectual Experiences

Peak Performance Program — Took part in program organized during school breaks by the Kenya Commercial Bank Foundation to encourage their scholarship recipients to develop full intellectual lives and improve their academic performance.

Kenya Orphans and Widows Program — Underwent training in raising awareness of HIV/AIDS and teaching community residents how to deal with persons living with the disease.

Solar water disinfection (SODIS) — Trained by WHO officers in cheap, effective method of disinfecting water. Used the knowledge to oversee water disinfection program at my primary school.

Construction work — Volunteered as manual laborer on community construction projects near my home, hoping to acquire basic skills relevant to the field of engineering.

Recent Reading —

Books: For Whom the Bell Tolls – Ernest Hemingway; The Sun Also Rises – Ernest Hemingway; 21 Speeches That Shaped Our World – Chris Abbott

Websites: edX Online Courses; Khan Academy; How Stuff Works

Activities

Activity 1	Community Service
Activity 2	Religious Groups
Activity 3	Environmental Groups
Activity 4	Political Groups
Activity 5	Martial Arts
For a sport, please indicate intended level of participation.	Club/Intramural/Recreational

EC Essay

Voluntary teaching at M.M. Chandaria and Our Lady of Nazareth primary schools was my most meaningful activity. Both schools are situated in sprawling slums and suffer acute shortages of teachers at times, especially during the school breaks.

In Kenya, many students remain at school during breaks in between terms, especially when preparing for the national primary school exam. During this time, I taught mathematics, science and English. Additionally, I would teach sex education—especially important because of the high rate of teen pregnancies in the neighborhood.

The dropout rates at both schools were also very high, so part of my responsibility was to motivate the students to persevere through hardships. As an alumna of M.M.Chandaria, I was a credible role model, and I believe my work at the schools has had some effect beyond my original purpose, which was only to express my gratitude to my former school.

Contacts

Have you previously applied to Harvard?	No
How have you learned about Harvard? List in order of influence	Harvard Student Contact, Tito Yak Kuol.
Additional contact	College Counselor / Teacher
Additional contact	Harvard Admissions Visit to Your Hometown
Additional contact	Website

Other Information

Please list the cities, states and countries where you have lived, with years of residence. Please list each location on a separate line with dates following (e.g., City, State, Country, mm/yyyy - mm/yyyy).

Limuru, Kiambu, Kenya, 08/1996 - 01/2008.

Please list additional location and date if applicable.

Nairobi, Kenya, 01/2008 to date.

Students Applying From Outside The US & Canada

FOR STUDENTS APPLYING FROM SCHOOLS OUTSIDE THE US AND CANADA: If interviews are available in your area have you had or have you scheduled an admissions interview?

No, but I plan to do so.

What specific plan do you have, if any, for using the education you hope to receive?

I plan to study electrical engineering. Kenya is a rapidly developing technological hub. With an electrical engineering background, I could work in fields ranging from mobile banking to private sector power projects. Regardless of the field, I could utilize my Harvard education to help transform my community and Kenya.

Affirmations

By submitting this application, I affirm my understanding of and agreement to the statements found here: <http://www.commonapp.org/affirmations>.